Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 1 of 12 · Question 3 part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 1 of 3 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
3(a)	**One** mark for each appropriate conclusion (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification of each conclusion through analysis/interpretation (maximum **two** marks). For example: • Doing a task that is more challenging and reasonably difficult leads to the most effective learning (1) which is shown by the group doing the reasonably difficult task improving by 30% which is the most of all groups (1). • Doing a task that is too difficult can lead to no improvement in learning a new concept (1) which is shown by the group doing the very complex task having no improvement to still achieving 50% by the end of the week (1). • Doing a very easy task gives less improvement in learning a new concept than a more challenging, reasonably difficult task (1) which is shown by the group doing the very easy task showing a 10% improvement by the end of the week compared a 30% improvement by those doing a more challenging, reasonably difficult task (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 1 of 12 · Question 3 part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 2 of 3 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
3(b)	**One** mark for identification of a strength/weakness (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification which must be linked to the strength/weakness identified (maximum **two** marks). For example: Strength • Alessia gave the students a test at the beginning of the week which gave them a baseline measure of performance on the new science concept (1) which enabled Alessia to accurately measure how effective the task given was as she could compare before to after with the same students which increases validity (1). • Alessia gave all the students in each group the same task with the same activities included so there were some controls (1) which is a strength because Alessia can test her findings about difficulty of task when learning a new concept for reliability to see if she gets consistent results from her students about learning. Weakness • Alessia gave the different tasks to her students in groups during their lessons at school so they could have been distracted or helped by others (1) which means that Alessia cannot be sure it was the task that led to the test performance at the end of the week as being helped by other students could have improved their understanding of the science concept (1). • Alessia only recruited her own students from a single school to investigate difficulty of task in learning a new concept so this lacks generalisability to all students (1) because her students may all have a high prior attainment so any conclusions about difficulty of task in learning something new would be affected by this and so not be representative of students in general (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 1 of 12 · Question 3 part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 3 of 3 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 2 of 12 · Question 9 part b · 4 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 1 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
9(a)	**One** mark for each conclusion made. (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification of each conclusion through analysis/interpretation. (maximum **two** marks). For example: • The participant with anterograde amnesia showed difficulty in learning new skills (1) because they scored at least 18 less on the picture task, which relied on learning after the onset of amnesia, compared to the other two participants (1). • The participant with retrograde amnesia scored only 40/100 vs. at least 80/100 compared to the other two participants on Task 2 (1), which shows that they found difficulty in remembering before the onset of their amnesia as the news events happened prior to their amnesia (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Question number	Answer	Mark
9(b)	**One** mark for identification of the strength / weakness (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification, which must be linked to the strength / weakness identified (maximum **two** marks). For example: Strength • Dekota used a healthy control participant to compare the amnesic participants to (1) which is a strength as they can see the impact of amnesia against the baseline measure scored by the control (1). Weakness • Dekota only recruited one participant with amnesia (or a control) for each condition (1) which is a weakness as each participant may have been unique in their amnesia so the study has limited generalisability to the target population of amnesics (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 2 of 12 · Question 9 part b · 4 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 2 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Section C
Psychological problems – How would psychological problems affect you?

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 3 of 12 · Question 3 part b · 4 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01 · extract 1 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
3(a)	**One** mark for demonstrating accurate understanding of Piaget and Inhelder's (1956) Three Mountains task. **One** mark for exemplification of how the study can be used to explain the scenario. For example: • Piaget and Inhelder (1956) reported that children who could not see the mountains from the doll's perspective were considered egocentric (1) and Sarah's daughter does not appear to be able to see the playground from the toy robot's perspective so she must be in the pre-operational stage (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(2)**

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 3 of 12 · Question 3 part b · 4 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01 · extract 2 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
3(b)	**One** mark for identification of each strength / weakness (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification which must be linked to the strength / weakness identified (maximum **two** marks). For example: Strength • Sarah's study took place in a real playground setting so it has high ecological validity (1) because her daughter would be more likely to act naturally when giving her perspective of what the toy robot could see as it was a real life setting (1). Weakness • The task of asking her daughter what the toy robot could see lacks mundane realism (1) because this is not a normal thing to ask a child who would be playing in a playground so the findings may lack validity (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	(4)

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 4 of 12 · Question 5 part b · 4 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01 · extract 1 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
5(a)	**One** mark for demonstrating accurate understanding of Piaget's Theory of Cognitive Development. **One** mark for exemplification of how the theory can be used to explain the scenario. For example: • Piaget's theory suggests that children acquire object permanence around 6 months old in the sensorimotor stage and therefore know objects exist even when they cannot see them (1). As Beth's daughter reaches behind the cushion for the ball and she is 8 months old it suggests she has developed object permanence and will know the ball still exists even when it cannot be seen (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	(2)

Question number	Answer	Mark
5(b)	**One** mark for identification of each strength or weakness (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification which must be linked to the strength or weakness identified (maximum **two** marks). For example: Strength • Beth's daughter is likely to behave like any 8 month old infant would do in their home environment so the investigation will have high ecological validity (1) as her daughter will be in a familiar setting so will feel comfortable and will show her everyday behaviour with the ball (1). Weakness • Beth only looked at the behaviour of one child so may not be representative all children of 8 months old (1) because her daughter may be more advanced than other children and so would not be a generalisable sample of the cognitive development at that age (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	(4)

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 4 of 12 · Question 5 part b · 4 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01 · extract 2 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Section B
Memory – How does your memory work?

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 5 of 12 · Question 8 part b · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 1 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
8(a)	**One** mark for accurate understanding of the Multi-store Model of Memory. **One** mark for exemplification of how the Multi-store Model of Memory can be used to explain the scenario. For example: • The Multi-store Model of Memory suggests there is a separate short term and long term store for information (1). The words remembered from the beginning of the list would be in the LTM, as they had been rehearsed whilst the ones in the middle were being read out, so the higher percentages recalled for these words supports the theory (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(2)**

Question number	Answer	Mark
8(b)	**One** mark for identification of the strength / weakness (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification, which must be linked to the strength / weakness identified (maximum **two** marks). For example: Strength • Every volunteer was given the same list of words to remember so the study can be tested for reliability (1) because each individual had to learn the same 20 words so it is replicable and consistency can be assessed over time (1). Weakness • Some of the words on the list might be more familiar to some volunteers so this could have affected the validity of Pablo's study (1) because someone who frequently used the train may have been more likely to remember that word than someone that does not so experience and exposure could have affected the words remembered (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 5 of 12 · Question 8 part b · 4 marks

2022 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 2 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 6 of 12 · Question 4 part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 1 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
4(a)	**One** mark for each appropriate conclusion (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification of each conclusion through analysis/interpretation (maximum **two** marks). For example: • One conclusion is that practice and effort improves juggling skills (1), which is shown by Sergio's niece being able to juggle for 10 seconds longer by day 7 (14 seconds) compared to day 1 (4 seconds) (1). • A conclusion could be that getting supportive messages praising effort helps to encourage practise and learning to juggle (1) which is shown by his niece being able to juggle for 10 seconds longer than his nephew by day 7, who did not get any messages (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	(4)

Question number	Answer	Mark
4(b)	**One** mark for identification of each weakness (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification which must be linked to the weakness identified (maximum **two** marks). For example: Weakness one • Sergio only used his own niece and nephew so the investigation lacks generalisability as they may not reflect others when juggling (1) as his niece may have been naturally gifted at juggling and her improvement may not have been shown by other individuals within the same time period (1). Weakness two • Sergio did not specify exactly how long his niece should practise for or check that his nephew did not practise juggling (1) so the lack of controls used in his investigation means that it is difficult to infer cause and effect as the practice and praise may not have actually caused his niece's improvement (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	(4)

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 6 of 12 · Question 4 part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 2 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Section B
Memory – How does your memory work?

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 7 of 12 · Question 9 part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 1 of 3 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
9(a)	**One** mark for accurate understanding of the Theory of Reconstructive Memory. **One** mark for exemplification of how the Theory of Reconstructive Memory can be used to explain the scenario. For example: • The theory of reconstructive memory suggests people change their original memory when recalling by using their own schema (1). Simon found some of his students used confabulation to recall a word similar to those on the list, such as the word 'sour' being similar to 'bitter', as it fits into the same schema (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	(2)

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 7 of 12 · Question 9 part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 2 of 3 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
9(b)	**One** mark for identification of the strength / weakness (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification, which must be linked to the strength / weakness identified (maximum **two** marks). For example: Strength • Simon gave all his students the same 6 words and the same 15 seconds to remember the words so there were some controls (1) which is a strength because Simon can test his findings about memory of the 6 words for reliability to see if he gets consistent results from his students about recall (1). Weakness • Simon only recruited one group of his own students to investigate memory so this lacks generalisability to all students (1) because his students may all have a very good prior memory ability so any conclusions about memory would be affected by this and so not be representative of students in general (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 7 of 12 · Question 9 part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 3 of 3 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 8 of 12 · Question 15 part a · 4 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01 · extract 1 of 2 · find part a in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
15(a)	**One** mark for identification of the strength / weakness (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification, which must be linked to the strength / weakness identified (maximum **two** marks). For example: Strength • Ishfaq gathered both qualitative and quantitative data through interviews and experiments with his brain-damaged patient so his findings could be tested for reliability (1) as the information collected from the interviews could be checked for consistency with the experimental data on the role of the corpus callosum (1). Weakness • Only one patient has been studied with damage to their corpus callosum so the investigation lacks generalisability (1) because the problems the patient suffers from may be unique to them and may not be representative of all people with damage to the corpus callosum (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 8 of 12 · Question 15 part a · 4 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01 · extract 2 of 2 · find part a in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
15(b)	**One** mark for accurate understanding of the role of the corpus callosum. **One** mark for exemplification of how the role of the corpus callosum can be used to explain the scenario. For example: • The corpus callosum is a bundle of fibres that transfers information from one hemisphere to the other (1) so the damage experienced by Ishfaq's patient may result in them being able to handle an object correctly but not being able to name it (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(2)**

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 9 of 12 · Question 17 part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 1 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
17(a)	**One** mark for each appropriate conclusion (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification of each conclusion through analysis/interpretation (maximum **two** marks). For example: • The training programme improved the ability of patients to recognise faces (1) because those in the training programme improved their performance by 19% from before to after the training programme (1). • The training programme was more effective than the control condition for the patients (1) which is shown by a similar performance before treatment but the training programme were 22% better on average than control at recognising faces at the end of treatment (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 9 of 12 · Question 17 part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 2 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
17(b)	**One** mark for identification of each strength (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification, which must be linked to the strength identified (maximum **two** marks). For example: Strength one • A strength is that Mattéo recorded the performance of those on the training programme before treatment to gain a baseline measure (1) which enabled Mattéo to accurately measure how effective the training programme was as he could compare before to after with the same patients which increases validity (1). Strength two • Mattéo used a control group in his study to compare with the treatment programme patients which increases validity (1) because he can compare the performance of patients with prosopagnosia with and without the training programme to see the impact of the treatment accurately (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 10 of 12 · Question 19 part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 1 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
19(a)	**One** mark for a conclusion made. **One** mark for justification of the conclusion through analysis/interpretation. For example: • The left hemisphere is involved in both verbal and spatial abilities (1). This is shown by the participant with damage to their left hemisphere performing poorly on both verbal and spatial tasks, scoring just 4% and 8% respectively (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(2)**

Question number	Answer	Mark
19(b)	**One** mark for identification of each strength/weakness (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification, which must be linked to each strength/weakness identified (maximum **two** marks). For example: Strength • Mikel gave both the brain-damaged participants the same tasks involving words and shapes so the investigation has a standardised procedure (1) which is a strength because the investigation involving verbal and spatial abilities in the roles of the hemispheres can be replicated to test for consistency over time in different brain-damaged patients (1). Weakness • Mikel only used a single participant with left or right hemisphere damaged so there is a lack of generalisability in his investigation of the role of the hemispheres (1) because the brain-damaged participants who did the word and shape tasks may have specific damage in their brain that is not representative of all people with left or right hemisphere damage (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 10 of 12 · Question 19 part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 2 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 11 of 12 · Question 20 part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 1 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
20(a)	**One** mark for each appropriate conclusion (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification of each conclusion through analysis/interpretation (maximum **two** marks). For example: • The presence of the stooges/confederates seemed to increase the conformity to majority influence to run in the morning (1) which is shown by an increase of 12-18 minutes use on the fifth running machine across the three days (1). • The presence of the stooges/confederates did not appear to influence conformity to majority influence to run in the afternoon (1) because there is very little difference on all three days with no consistent pattern and differences of only 2-3 minutes across the three days (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Question number	Answer	Mark
20(b)	**One** mark for identification of the strength / weakness (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification, which must be linked to the strength / weakness identified (maximum **two** marks). For example: Strength • Ada used a controlled two-hour period in the morning and afternoon sessions so could test for reliability (1) because using the same time period in each session meant her study was replicable and direct comparisons could be made to check for consistency (1). Weakness • Ada only went to her local gym so her results about conformity to majority influence may not be generalisable to other gyms (1) because people who frequent other gyms in different areas may have responded differently to the stooges/confederates so the results may only be representative of her local gym (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 11 of 12 · Question 20 part b · 4 marks

2023 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 2 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

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Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 12 of 12 · Question 23 part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 1 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract

Question number	Answer	Mark
23(a)	**One** mark for identification of each conclusion (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification of each conclusion through analysis/interpretation (maximum **two** marks). For example: Conclusion one • The presence of the authority figure influenced the level of obedience of the train passengers (1) because there were 20% more who obeyed the request to leave by a single exit if the authority figure was present compared to when they were absent (1). Conclusion two • The use of a uniform increased the level of obedience of the train passengers (1) because there were 30% more who obeyed the request to leave by a single exit if the authority figure wore a uniform compared to casual clothes (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Question number	Answer	Mark
23(b)	**One** mark for identification of each strength/weakness (maximum **two** marks). **One** mark for justification, which must be linked to each strength/weakness identified (maximum **two** marks). For example: Strength • Hannah conducted her investigation in a real-life setting of a train station so the findings will have high levels of ecological validity (1) because the train passengers participating are in their natural setting of a train station so are more likely to act as they usually would when being given the order when exiting the station (1). Weakness • Hannah conducted her investigation during a busy rush hour period at the station so extraneous variables may have influenced the passengers behaviour (1) because high passenger numbers during the busy period may have forced the participants to use multiple exits so they did not get crushed, which will have affected the validity of her results (1). Accept any other appropriate response.	**(4)**

Type MS · Strengths and weaknesses of a study

Answer 12 of 12 · Question 23 part b · 4 marks

2024 JUN · Paper 01 · extract 2 of 2 · find part b in this mark scheme extract